

THE PROMPT FORMULA

COMPONENT	WHAT IT DOES	EXAMPLE
TASK	What you need done	"Identify the 3 most vulnerable programs by enrollment and market demand"
CONTEXT	Information the LLM needs	Enrollment data, program structures, job market files
OUTPUT	How you need results	"Table with program name, enrollment trend, market score, and recommendation"
CONSTRAINTS	What the LLM should NOT do	"Do not suggest adding budget. Do not hedge."
ROLE	Perspective for the analysis	"You are a skeptical accreditation reviewer"

GRANT OPPORTUNITY RESEARCH

CURRICULUM GAP ANALYSIS

ROLE: Grant reviewer who has rejected 80% of applications this cycle

TASK: Identify 5 federal grant opportunities aligned with our priorities

CONTEXT: [Attach enrollment-data.md] **Priorities:** STEM retention, faculty development, student mental health. Can manage grants up to \$500K.

OUTPUT: Table (agency, program, max award, alignment, deadline, competitiveness). For top 3: why we fit, what is required, realistic odds.

CONSTRAINTS: Only opportunities where we have genuine competitive advantage. No aspirational long-shots.

ROLE: Hiring manager screening graduates from our program

TASK: Compare [program] curriculum against job market requirements

CONTEXT: [Attach program file from catalog/] [Attach job market data]

OUTPUT: List of critical gaps (50%+ of postings), Market Readiness Score (0-100), and a specific course proposal to close the top 3 gaps

CONSTRAINTS: Do not recommend adding credit hours. Do not suggest the professional exam compensates for skill gaps



Three Types of Context

- **Inline** — facts written directly in the prompt. Fast. Limited to what you remember
- **File-based** — a document attached to the conversation. Writing samples, reports, datasets
- **Knowledge base** — a structured collection of files representing institutional knowledge. Scales across people and conversations

Three Signs of a Bad Prompt

1. **Generic output** — you forgot to include context about your institution
2. **Unusable output** — you forgot to specify constraints (budget, timeline, resources)
3. **Consultant-speak** — you asked for "best practices" instead of solving a specific problem

Ethics Checklist

No confidential student data (FERPA)
No personnel information
No sensitive strategic plans in shared/public LLM platforms
Use anonymized or representative data for practice
Verify all LLM outputs against authoritative sources
Cite LLM assistance in formal documents when appropriate

AI Burnout Warning Signs

Feeling dread about "falling behind" on AI developments — this is structural, not personal. You cannot keep up. **Choose depth over breadth.**
Losing track of time during AI-assisted work sessions — strategic thinking is high-intensity cognitive work. **Set time boundaries.**
Mental fatigue disproportionate to apparent activity — "just typing" can be as exhausting as any demanding professional task.
Guilt about not learning fast enough — the field moves faster than any individual can track. **Acceptance is the productive response.**

